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■ Sheikh Khaled and Sheikh Theyab Bin Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Chairman of Etihad Rail, during the inauguration of the Mohamed Bin Zayed City Passenger Train Station in Abu Dhabi.

Etihad Rail announces start date

Sheikh Khaled inaugurates the Mohamed Bin Zayed City station

DUBAI
BY ANUPAM VARMA
News and Business Editor

The first Etihad Rail passenger train will take to the tracks in just under a week's time, marking a significant moment in the UAE's transit service.

An introductory operational phase of passenger rail services between Abu Dhabi and Fujairah will begin on June 30, cutting the journey time to just 1 hour and 45 minutes, it was announced yesterday.

The Dubai Train Station and Al Dhaid Train Station will open with the official launch on September 30, followed by stations

in Al Dhafra on December 30, authorities revealed. The route will be complete upon the opening of Sharjah Train Station on March 30, 2027.

Fare breakup

Fares on Abu Dhabi-Fujairah route will start at Dh55 for Comfort Class and Dh120 for Premium Class. The passenger rail fleet comprises 13 trains, each with a capacity of up to 400 passengers. Customers can now book journeys and purchase tickets through a range of convenient channels, including the Etihad Rail mobile application and official website, starting yesterday.

The announcement came as Sheikh Khaled Bin Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi and Chairman of the Abu Dhabi Executive Council, inaugurated the Mohamed Bin Zayed City Passenger Train Station in Abu Dhabi.

Sheikh Khaled toured the station's key facilities and amenities and reviewed its information management systems and operational readiness procedures. He was also briefed on the station's advanced infrastructure, future plans to increase capacity, measures to facilitate passenger movement during peak hours, and the smart solutions and customer service offerings designed to deliver the highest standards of operational efficiency and service excellence.

Sheikh Khaled affirmed that the passenger train project reflects the UAE's vision for a fully integrated transport network, enhancing inter-emirate connectivity, supporting sustainable growth through the efficient movement of people and goods, and opening new horizons for investment, tourism and urban development.

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Dubai tenants to get 'Flexi Rents' payment relief

MONTHLY RENTAL PAYMENTS, FLEXIBLE INSTALMENTS, FEE WAIVERS ON OFFER

DUBAI
BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

Dubai has introduced "Flexi Rent", aimed at making renting more accessible by reducing the financial burden of large upfront payments.

Under the initiative, tenants will be able to choose from a range of payment schedules, including monthly, quarterly and semi-annual instalments, depending on the property and landlord participating in the programme. The new Flexi Rent model introduces alternative payment structures that allow tenants to spread costs over shorter intervals.

Under the first phase of the programme, participating landlords and property management companies will offer a range of payment options tailored to different tenant needs.

More options

These include monthly rental payments, quarterly instalments and semi-annual plans. In some cases, payment schedules may be extended for up to 12 months, enabling residents to better align rent payments with their monthly income and financial obligations.

The initiative also introduces a number of additional concessions designed to ease the cost of renting. Depending on the

property owner or management company, tenants may benefit from grace periods, revised payment schedules and promotional offers. Some participating landlords may also waive rental increases or administrative fees typically associated with delayed cheque payments.

Tenants will be able to make payments through a variety of methods, including credit cards, debit cards and traditional cheques, offering greater convenience and flexibility.

Available to all

Importantly, the scheme is available not only to new tenants but also to existing residents. Those currently renting under annual or multiple-cheque contracts can approach participating landlords and property management companies to explore whether their payment arrangements can be revised under the Flexi Rent framework.

To support the rollout, Dubai Land Department (DLD) signed cooperation agreements with 12 major real estate companies operating in Dubai. These include Wasl Properties, Deyaar Property Management, Dubai World Real Estate, Modern Real Estate, Dubai Investment Real Estate, SBK Real Estate, Rocky Real Estate, SRG Properties, Harbor Real Estate, Driven Properties and Al Showaib Real Estate, among others.

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